the foot of the View Point, which would be perhaps 150 to 200 ft uphill. While climbing up, there would be small stands displaying some weapons or equipment every 50 ft or so, where the visiting officer would be briefed; but the real motive was to allow everyone to catch their breath in these high-altitude areas. The first couple of times, I went straightway to the top, saying that I would see the displays on the way down. My MA, Brig Vikrant Naik, had to discreetly tell me to go slow and stop as planned, as I was leaving everyone else, himself included, huffing and puffing behind.

While at Srinagar, I called on the Lieutenant Governor, Shri Manoj Sinha, and reviewed the security situation. More than a year had elapsed since the abrogation of Article 370 and there had been a perceptible improvement in the law-and-order situation. However, development activities had yet to really get rolling and the LG remarked that the entrenched local bureaucracy was proving to be a stumbling block. Shri Manoj Sinha was not a person to take things lying down and showed clear intent to get things moving even if it meant sacking a few of the more recalcitrant *babus*. While at the Corps HQ as part of the briefing, I was also told of an operation that had been carried out by 62 RR in mid-July, wherein three terrorists had been killed in an orchard. There had been murmurs right from the day of the operation that something was amiss, as it was not supported by any intelligence inputs. There was no immediate identification either, or reaction by the locals, who know exactly who is who. Later, it emerged that they were migrant labourers from Rajouri, not terrorists at all, and who prima facie appeared to have been gunned down in cold blood. In keeping with the zero tolerance to HR violations policy, an inquiry was immediately ordered, which confirmed our suspicions. My experience of operations as a CO during my

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